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BCMENLS 201

**II Semester B.Com. Examination, June/July 2025
(S.E.P.) (2024 – 25 Batch Onwards)
ENGLISH LANGUAGE**

Time : 3 Hours

Max. Marks : 80

**SECTION – A
(Prose)**



I. A) Answer **any one** of the following in about **200** words : **(1×10=10)**

- 1) How does Chief Seathl highlight the White man's atrocities against nature in "A Simple Philosophy" ?
- 2) How is gender discrimination within a patriarchal society brought out through the use of a child narrator in "Girls" ?
- 3) Do you feel that Shyamali was a woman of strength ? Substantiate your answer from the story "Neech".
- 4) Describe the friendship between Cabuliwallah and Mini in "Cabuliwallah".

B) Answer **any two** of the following in about **100** words **each** : **(2×5=10)**

- 1) Why does Chief Seathl find the White man's offer strange ?
- 2) Why does the episode of Chaitya Shukla Ashtami leave the child narrator feeling confused ?
- 3) Why did Shyamali tell Sultana that her husband was dead ?
- 4) What is Mark Twain's advice to the youth on reading books ?
- 5) Why does the speaker hesitate to allow Mini to meet Rahmun at first ?

**SECTION – B
(Poetry)**

II. A) Answer **any one** of the following in about **200** words : **(1×10=10)**

- 1) Bring out the essential elements of true love as defined by William Shakespeare in "Sonnet 116".
- 2) How does the poem "Once Upon a Time" by Gabriel Okara display the pain of growing up and the loss of innocence ? Discuss.
- 3) How does Bukowski's "Blue Bird" reflect the internal struggle of the speaker ? Explain.
- 4) Discuss the major themes of the poem 'Sandals and I'.

P.T.O.



B) Answer **any two** of the following in about **100 words each** : **(2×5=10)**

- 1) Why does the poet compare true love to a "pole star" in "Sonnet 116" ?
- 2) How does the speaker distinguish between "laugh with their hearts" and "laugh with their teeth" in the poem, "Once Upon a Time" ?
- 3) How does the speaker express his devotion to God in the poem, "Sandals and I" ?
- 4) What does the speaker want to do with the blue bird in the poem "Blue Bird" ?
- 5) How does the imagery of the "terrible fish" contribute to the tone and themes of the poem "Mirror" ?

SECTION – C
(Grammar and Composition)

Unit – I



III. Read the following passage and answer the questions that follow :

A woman was waiting at an airport one night with several long hours before her flight. She hunted for a book in the airport shop, bought a bag of cookies and found a place to draw. She was engrossed in her book, but happen to see that the man beside her, as bold as could be, grabbed a cookie or two from the bag between which she tried to ignore to avoid a scene. She read, munched cookies and watched the clock as the gusty "Cookie thief" diminished her stock. She was getting-more irritated as the minutes ticked by thinking, "If I wasn't so nice, I'd blacken his eye!" With each cookie she took, he took one too. When only one was left, she wondered what he'd do. With a smile on his face and a nervous laugh, he took the last cookie and broke it in half. He offered her half, as he ate the other. She snatched it from him and thought, "O brother, this guy has some nerve and he's also rude. Why, he didn't even show any gratitude !"

She had never known when she had been so galled and sighed with relief when her flight was called. She gathered her belongings and headed for the gate, refusing to look back at the "Thieving ingrate". She boarded the plane and sank in her seat, she sought her book, which was almost complete. As she reached in her baggage, she gasped with surprise. There was her bag of cookies in front of her eye!" If mine are here," She moaned with despair, "Then the others were his and he tried to share!" Too late to apologize, she realized with grief that she was the rude one, the ingrate, the thief !

a) Suggest a suitable caption for the above passage.



IV. Do as directed :

- 1) Choose the right **synonym** from the passage (given in question No. III) for the underlined word in the sentence. (2×1=2)
 - a) She was annoyed by the constant noise from the construction site.
 - b) She expressed her thankfulness for the kindness and support she received.
- 2) Fill in the blanks with the appropriate **antonym** of the word underlined : (2×1=2)
 - a) Vikas didn't seem to be timid; in fact, he seemed as _____ as he could be.
 - b) Sometimes wisdom lies not in accepting an offer but in _____ it.
- 3) Fill in the blanks in the following sentences with a single **homonym** : (2×1=2)
 - a) i) The detective found a _____ for the finger prints at the crime scene.
ii) The teams played well in the cricket _____.
 - b) i) I need to go to the _____ to withdraw some money.
ii) We sat on the _____ of the river and watched the sunset.
- 4) Match the words in Column **A** with the right **collocations** given in Column **B** :

Column A

Column B

(2×1=2)

a. Layoff

i. Smart

b. Punching

ii. Staff

iii. Bag

Unit – II

V. Do as directed :

- 1) Rewrite the following sentences in **active or passive voice** as directed : (5×1=5)
 - a) The researchers were conducting an experiment. (Change into passive voice)
 - b) The publishing house will release the author's latest novel. (Change into passive voice)
 - c) Can Rajesh set up a meeting with the director ? (Change into passive voice)
 - d) The window was broken by the storm. (Change into active voice)
 - e) The teacher praised the class for the excellent performance. (Change into passive beginning with "The Class")



2) Rewrite the following sentences in **reported speech** :

(5×1=5)

- a) Mohan said, "I am returning to Chennai next Sunday".
- b) The officer said, "Some of the animals have been saved".
- c) The teacher said, "Study hard so that you can pass the exam".
- d) "Do you practise regularly?" said the coach to the athlete.
- e) The teacher said to the students, "How brilliantly you have solved this difficult problem !"



3) Write a dialogue in about **ten to twelve** sentences choosing **any one** of the situations given below :

(1×5=5)

- a) Customer talking to an online market customer care representative for a refund, after having received the damaged material.
- b) Two cousins meeting after a long time at a family reunion.

4) Write a newspaper report in about **100** words on **any one** of the topics given below :

(1×5=5)

- a) Annual Day celebration.
- b) Annual Sports Meet.

5) Write an essay in about **200** words on **any one** of the topics given below. Use the hints given below the topic to develop the essay.

(1×10=10)

- a) Drugs — menace to the society
Effects on health and environment — interference with the brain's development — impact on educational environment — impact on workplace — economic cost on the nation state.
- b) Power of reading in a digital age
Importance of reading — Enhances knowledge, creativity, critical thinking — develops language and communication skills — boosts concentration — access to vast amount of information online, E-books, digital libraries make reading convenient, online learning platforms — negative aspects — shorter attention span, preference to videos over written content — reduces reading habit, digital eye strain.
